

Luca Vicisano

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Education

University of California, Berkeley

B.A. Economics, B.A. Political Economy, Data Science Minor (planned)

Coursework: Econometrics, Empirical Methods for Political Science, Data Science, Discrete Math & Probability GPA 3.8

University of Alicante – UC Education Abroad Program

Coursework: Game Theory, Networks, Economics of Development, History of Economic Analysis

Berkeley, CA

Expected May 2028

Alicante, Spain | Fall 2026

Experience

The Daily Californian – Data Section

Senior Staff (contributing remotely while abroad)

Head Editor, Data Section (Senior Editorial Board)

Berkeley, CA

Sept 2026 – Present

Jan 2026 – Sept 2026

- Ran the paper's data section (~15 reporters and developers at a time, 25 overall); pitched majority of the stories, often acquiring data and running the first analysis prior to assigning the story to staff
- **Canvas breach (co-byline):** processed and geocoded hacking group ShinyHunters' dark-web list of ~8,800 alleged targets of the Instructure breach, led a six-person data-cleaning team, and wrote the story behind a searchable international map
- **UCPD body cameras (contributor):** pushed for the records request that produced arrest footage legal experts said undercut the police chief's account of felony vandalism charges; identified and interviewed experts and managed the reporting
- Pitched, analyzed and drafted stories later handed to staff, including FEC and Secretary of State campaign-finance filings by Berkeley residents and UC employees, CalFresh access and \$5M in student transit savings
- Oversaw data reporting for two DOJ Epstein Files investigations into Jeffrey Epstein's ties to UC Berkeley
- Kept reporting under own byline: a 45% jump in campus sexual harassment reports (analysis, graphics, writing); Berkeley's shelter cutting ties with a rescue under felony investigation; AI grade-inflation graphics from 30,000+ scraped grades
- Developed section systems: pitch tracker that keeps research and datasets so tabled stories can be revived, long-term story tracking, weekly editor–writer reviews, joint news–data investigations and a recruiting pipeline (16 hires)

Deputy Editor, Data Section

May 2025 – Jan 2026

- Conceived and analyzed investigation tracing hundreds of thousands of anonymous Wikipedia edits to UC campus networks by matching scraped edit histories (Wikimedia API) to UC IP ranges; uncovered university staff reframing articles
- Pitched and built datasets for stories on \$1.2M in ASUC funding across 400+ student groups, the hometowns of 850+ Cal athletes and eight years of student-election turnout across 26 fee referendums; edited all
- Trained 16 new staff; taught workshops on web scraping, Google Apps Script, Sheets, Datawrapper and D3; published projects to the desk's Gatsby site through GitHub pull requests

Staff Data Reporter

Sept 2024 – May 2025

- Built an original four-year dataset of ASUC officeholders' Greek affiliations from chapter records, campaign materials and social media; found Greek members (3–4% of undergraduates) held 30–40% of ASUC seats; reported, wrote and visualized

Berkeley Political Review – Staff Writer

Sept 2024 – June 2025

- Reported on housing and crime policy, including Berkeley's missing-middle zoning fight; interviewed city councilmembers

Office of Berkeley City Councilmember Rigel Robinson – Research Intern

June 2023 – Aug 2023

- Researched public housing policy and drafted memos recommending solutions to Berkeley's housing shortage

Baker and Commons – Barista, Cashier, Kitchen Prep

May 2025 – Aug 2026

Ongoing Investigations & Independent Projects

- **Police surveillance:** negotiating CPRA release of a week of Berkeley PD Flock license-plate reader data with pseudonymized plate IDs to measure how the cameras track repeat vehicles
- **Rent control:** obtained bulk unit-level Rent Board data via CPRA; built a Python geocoding pipeline to map rents citywide
- **Reading loads:** built a Python pipeline (CalNet LDAP, directory scraping, Google People API) and an Apps Script mailer to collect syllabi from faculty and measure how assigned reading has changed
- **Public money:** reverse-engineered Berkeley's NetFile API to bulk-collect officials' Form 700 financial disclosures; pressing UC's Office of the President via CPRA for its Blackstone contracts

Skills & Languages

Code: Python (pandas, NumPy, requests), R, SQL, Git/GitHub, Google Apps Script, JavaScript; learning D3, Svelte and QGIS

Data & reporting: public records (40+ CPRA requests), scraping and API reverse-engineering (REST, GraphQL),

LLM-assisted document extraction, geocoding, econometrics (OLS, DiD, IV, RDD), Datawrapper, Leaflet, Adobe Premiere

Languages: Spanish (professional working, B2–C1), Italian (basic)